

The 'design' activity

Design: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to create **prototypes and specifications** for products and services, detailing their functionality, user experience, and operational framework.

Success metrics

- Quality of the product specifications and prototypes.
- Design cycle time.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the 'design' activities.

Design: overview

Design is a dynamic activity that involves:

- creating new ideas
- adapting to changes
- generating solutions.

Digital product and service design uses technology and organizational resources to create **prototypes** and **specifications**.

Depending on the agreed positioning, strategy, and portfolio, organizations may adopt different **approaches** to product and service design:

- **Proactive:** anticipate needs.
- **Reactive:** respond to requirements.



Design always includes service interactions and experience.

Design: key definitions

The design activity produces **two key outputs** that guide development and ensure alignment: product specifications and product prototypes.

Product/service specification

A detailed document that outlines critical aspects, requirements, and characteristics of a product to be built. It typically includes descriptions of the product's features, functionalities, technical requirements, performance criteria, and user interface details.



Product/service prototype

An initial version of a product that demonstrates its basic form, functionality, and operational capabilities. It is used to test and refine the product's design and functionality and test hypotheses. Prototypes vary in complexity and purpose, ranging from visual mockups to fully functional models.

Design: Human-centred design

A user-focused approach to design

What is Human-Centred Design (HCD)?

- A problem-solving approach prioritizing users' needs and experiences.
- Rooted in empathy and iterative process.
- Strong focus on user.

HCD is guided by principles:

- Focus on users and their tasks.
- User involvement throughout design.
- Iterative design and evaluation.
- Full user experience considered.
- Multidisciplinary skills and perspectives.

Design: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'design' activity comprises four steps:

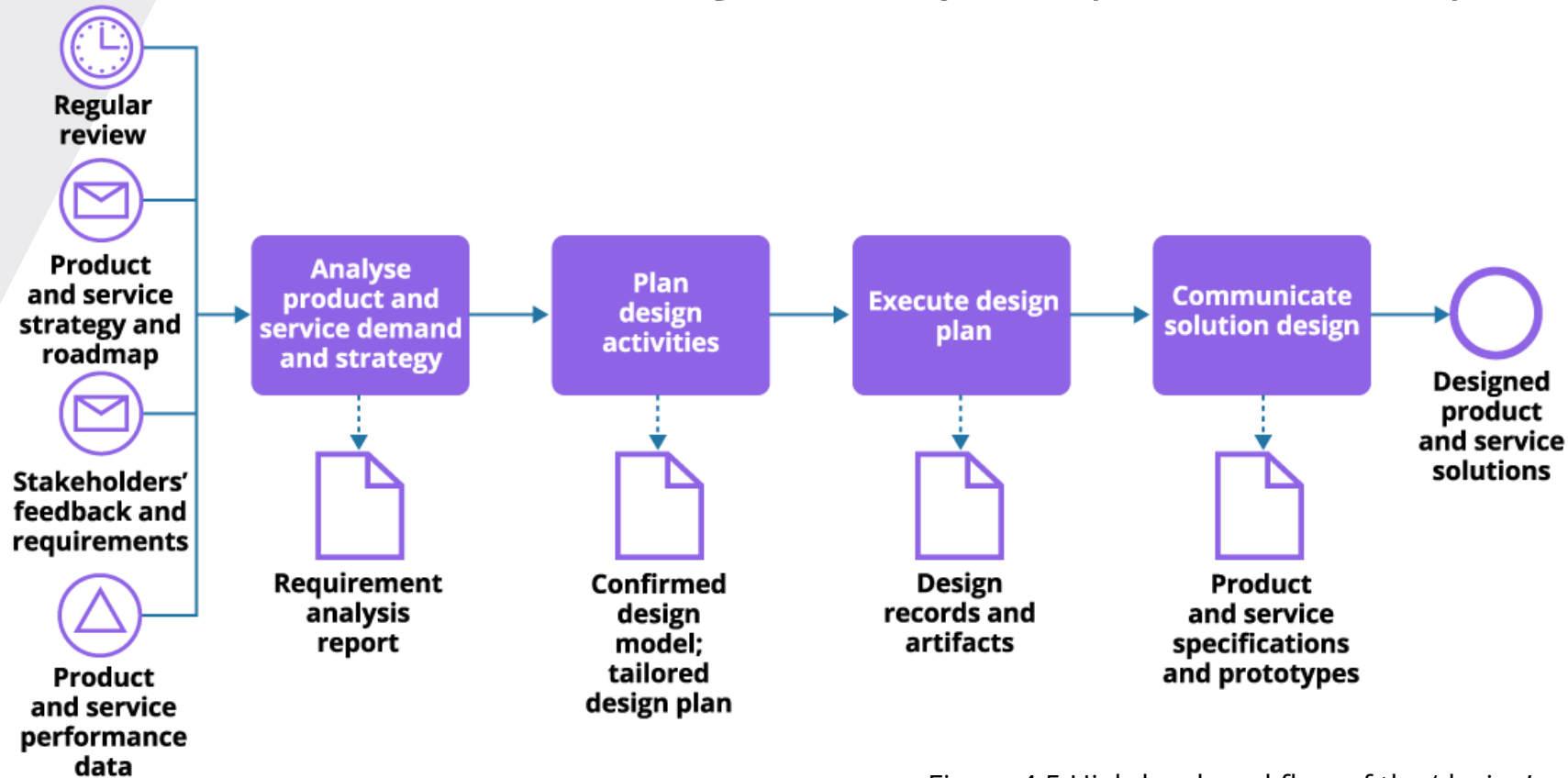
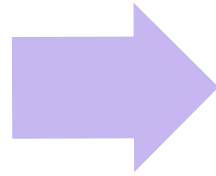


Figure 4.5 High-level workflow of the 'design' activity

Design: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- In some cases, specialized design teams.

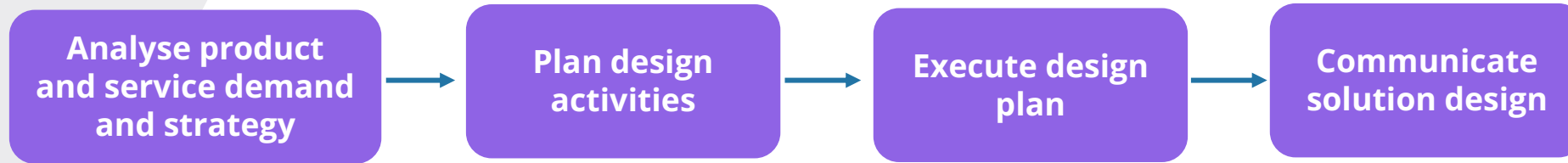


Outputs

- Product and service specifications and prototypes.



Design: management practices



Enabling practices	
Architecture management	Organizational change management
Availability management	Portfolio management
Business analysis	Project management
Capacity and performance management	Risk management
Continual improvement	Service continuity management
Information security management	Service design
Infrastructure and platform management	Service financial management
Measurement and reporting	Software development and management
Monitoring and event management	

Supporting practices
IT asset management
Knowledge management
Problem management
Service catalogue management
Service configuration management
Service level management
Supplier management